

PUBLIC ENTANGLES

Shilpa Shetty is in a public relations soup. Soon after her *Celebrity Big Brother*-success, she hired PR guru Max Clifford to turn her new-found fame into a success story. But even as their contract ended recently, it became clear that the plan has gone horribly wrong. British tabloids splashed stories of Shetty wrecking London-based businessman's marriage last weekend. Clifford says he found it impossible to work with her. Meanwhile, the actor's new PR firm, Sterling Media, is on the defence. "It's just a case of sour grapes," dismisses CEO Teji Singh. Quite a cliff-hanger, eh?

"Protection is an important part of PR. We are not protecting or promoting Shilpa any more."

—MAX CLIFFORD



Bedi Battle

Supercop Kiran Bedi, 58, is furious at being overlooked for the post of Delhi police commissioner. The country's first IPS officer and a Magsaysay Award winner, she is now all set to hold her own against this "injustice". Currently posted as director-general, Bureau for Police Research and Development, Bedi is angry that Special Commissioner Y.S. Dadwal, two years her junior, has been picked for the post. "I have always stood against injustice and will continue to do so," she said. Once a fire-brand, always a fire-brand.



VIVEK SINGH

Next Change

Even as **Sridevi** makes covert plans for a big filmi comeback, she will be making a guest appearance in Raj Kumar Santoshi's *Halla Bol* with hubby Boney Kapoor. "We are toying with some ideas but unless we finalise the subject, we can't say when Sri will make her comeback," Kapoor says. With Madhuri Dixit returning to the arc lights, looks like Sridevi will be back to stake her claim soon.



SACHIN KADVEKAR FOTOCORP

FASHION WALTZ

Here's an Indo-Brit cocktail that's got everyone in a tizzy. Amrit Maghera, a 24-year-old from the UK, shook a leg as part of a dance troupe in *Kabhi Alvida Naa Kehna* and *Jhoom Barabar Jhoom*. And now the singer-dancer, who has performed with Kanye West, has been signed as the new face of Lakme. "This is a dream-come-true," says Maghera, all poised to walk the ramp for Manish Malhotra's LFW finale. She's brushing up her Hindi now in case Bollywood comes knocking.



■ Compiled by **Kimi Dangor**

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Ab har ghar mein Sachin!

Sixers!

Now off the field and on your breakfast table.